

patience, and lots of practice to shift our thoughts. After establishing the new balanced thought, rate how much you believe in the new thought on a scale of 0 – 100.

BEST FRIEND TECHNIQUE

The Best Friend Technique is designed to help you gain some objectivity on the situation. It helps to expand your limited perspective and invite more self compassion and empathy. This technique poses some variation of the following question: "If your best friend was in this situation, what would you say to them? If you have a really wise and loving best friend, what would they say to you if you told them your thoughts?"

RE RATE YOUR EMOTIONS/MOOD

Once you have challenged and reframed the thought to a more alternative balanced thought, it is important to re rate your Emotions/Mood on a scale of 0-100 in column 8. We may not entirely buy into the new balanced thought at first but we can take notice of how we are feeling after we have gone through the process of putting our hot thought on trial.

HOME PRACTICE: For this week's home practice, experiment completing an entire thought record from columns 1 -8 about a situation that caused an emotional response. You can also complete the remaining sections of the thought record from last week's home practice. The next pages have two sample thought records if you need any further help.